

REFLECTIONS ON 9/11



KEITH MEYERS/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Listen to This Tour Guide. She Lived It.

25 Years Later, Telling Hushed Visitors About the Day Everything Changed

By MICHAEL WILSON

The tour begins outside a Burger King on Liberty Street in Lower Manhattan, and the guide explains why. People forget that this was commandeered by the police on Sept. 11, 2001, as a staging area amid the chaos, “NYPD Temp HQ” spray-painted over the front door.

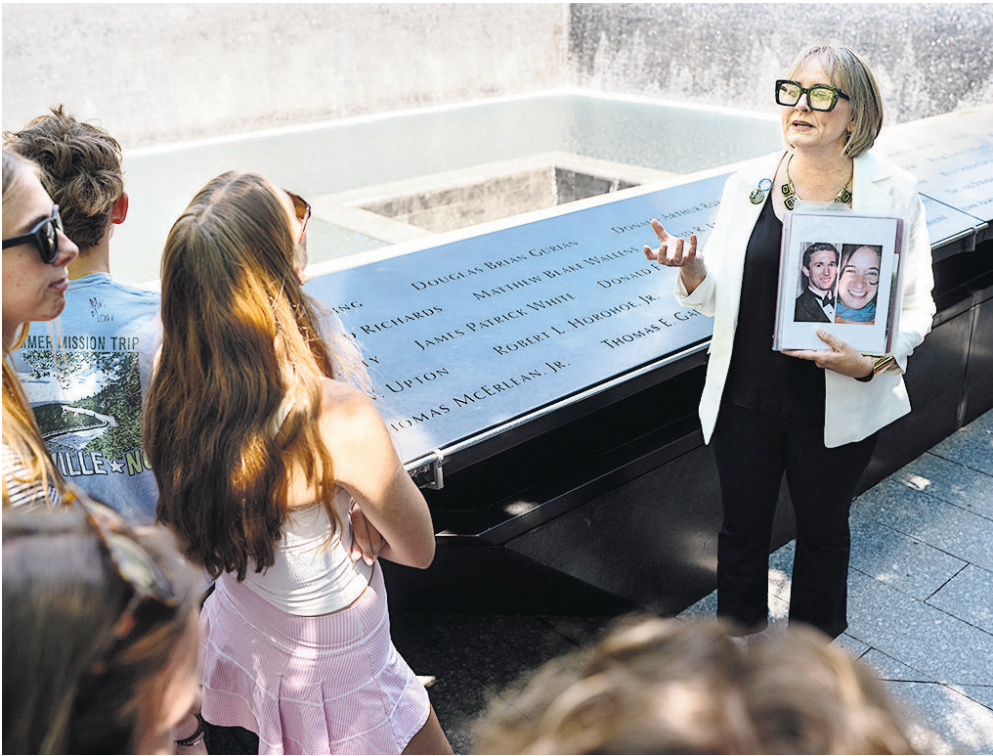
What follows is a very specific narrative of the events of that day as told by a very specific guide, Christina Stanton, who lived it firsthand. She continues to watch it unfold, 25 years on.

The first stop: an elevated park just south of where the twin towers stood. “I want to draw your attention to the yellow building back there,” she directed a school group from Indiana during a tour this May. She pointed out 21 West Street, where she moved with her husband, Brian, in July 2001. They were newlyweds, living on the 24th floor with a fabulous terrace.

She was 31 then, and had been a licensed tour guide for six years. “It was supposed to be my hustle,” she explained, adopting a haughty accent. “I’m a Broadway actress.”

She gave tours all over Manhattan. Her World Trade Center tour, close to home, began and ended at the 25-ton Koenig Sphere in the plaza between the towers. She’d once

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JAMES ESTRIN/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Christina Stanton, with photos of friends who died on Sept. 11, 2001, led a tour at the 9/11 Memorial reflecting pools. “I have some agency,” she said, “in keeping these things alive.”

A Special Section

It has been 25 years since the attacks that transformed New York City, America and the world. Inside, a look back at the day and the years since, tributes to who and what was lost, and a glimpse into the future.

**IN PHOTOS** Keith Meyers, a New York Times photographer for 26 years, described his fascination with the twin towers; he took countless pictures (including the one above, from 1986), tucking them into cityscapes whenever he could. D10

**DAN BARRY** “If asked, I will tell these stories again and again, if only to wage a private war against the inevitable erasure of time.” D2

**LEGACIES** A baby when his mother was killed, one man and the grandmother who raised him are still struggling to find peace. D6

**THEIR NAMES** Nearly 3,000 were killed in the attacks in New York, Virginia and Pennsylvania. D16

HOUTHIS’ SEIZURE  
OF RED SEA PORT  
RAISES OIL RISKS

SAUDI ALLY PUSHED OUT

Militia Tied to Iran Gets  
Closer to Control of  
a Choke Point

This article is by **Saeed Al-Batati, Shuaib Almosawa and Vivian Nereim.**

AL-MUKALLA, Yemen — The Iran-backed Houthi militia captured a strategic Red Sea port city on Thursday, according to two Yemeni officials, in a sweeping ground offensive that could give the group greater control over an important shipping route and further destabilize energy markets.

The Houthis pushed out forces allied with the Yemeni government, which is backed by Saudi Arabia, to seize the city of Mokha as well as its port, according to a local official in the city and a senior provincial official. Both spoke on the condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to speak to the news media.

Mokha has been the focus of several days of fierce ground battles between the Houthis and the internationally recognized government.

The two sides have been at war since 2014, when the Houthis seized Yemen’s capital, Sanaa. Soon after, a Saudi-led military coalition began a bombing campaign to try to restore the government to power, plunging the impoverished nation into a devastating war. A fragile truce, reached in 2022, has unraveled in recent months.

A video circulating online and verified by The New York Times shows several pickup trucks with groups of armed men standing in their cargo beds driving through a main road in Mokha. A person behind the camera is heard saying, “Death to America, death to Israel,” part of a Houthi slogan.

For Saudi Arabia and its Yemeni allies, the capture of Mokha is a major setback, raising questions about their ability to constrain the Houthis.

“It will put the U.S. and the Saudis and their allies in a much tighter situation than they already are,” said Farea Al-Muslimi, a Yemen specialist at Chatham House, a research institution in London.

For the Houthis, who are increasingly demanding to be treated as the country’s legitimate government — and be granted the power and resources that come with that — taking Mokha is a significant victory. It also puts an ally of Iran one step closer to controlling a maritime choke point.

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Missing in Trump Census Plan:  
Race Data and Some Migrants

By ZOLAN KANNO-YOUNGS

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration is proposing to no longer count immigrants without green cards in the 2030 census or ask about race and ethnicity, part of an overhaul that would redefine who counts as a U.S. resident in the eyes of the federal government.

The sweeping measures would upend a process that helps determine the allotment of congressional seats, billions of dollars in federal funding and policies to address systemic disparities.

The proposed regulations, published online on Wednesday, would not count noncitizens without green cards in the 2030 census, a significant departure from the process stipulated by the Constitution to occur every 10 years.

Historically, the census has asked Americans about their race and ethnicity and counted all U.S. residents regardless of their immigration status.

The overhaul also would bar the U.S. census from asking Americans about their sexual orientation.

While the proposals are likely to face legal challenges, the changes would remove not only undocumented immigrants from the official population count used to determine congressional seats, but also immigrants who are in the United States legally and have yet to secure green cards or citizenship. As a result, areas with more immigrants, which tend to vote

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At Convention, G.O.P. Selects  
Fear as Its Weapon of Choice

By LISA LERER

DALLAS — The photos plastered in the hallways were all of President Trump. Jackets were bedazzled with his name. And the red hats dotting the audience on the floor of the convention hall were embroidered with MAGA, his indelible political slogan.

And yet, at a gathering that fans and foes alike had nicknamed the “Trump-a-palooza,” the president and his Republican allies spent more time whipping up fears about the specter of socialism, communism and even anarchy than they did trumpeting the successes of his administration.

As they took the stage at the party’s unusual midterm gathering in Dallas on Wednesday night, amid growing Republican anxiety about the midterm elections, speaker after speaker focused on what they characterized as an urgent threat to American life: a Democratic Party they claimed had veered beyond its traditional liberal principles into a dangerous, un-American ideology.

Democrats running for Congress were “evil.” They were “communists and anarchists.” And they wanted to turn the country into “a socialist hellscape.”

“I call it the Bolshevik Revolution in the Democratic Party,” said Representative Steve

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Supreme Court Again Blocks  
G.O.P.-Backed Missouri Map

By ANN E. MARIMOW and MITCH SMITH

The U.S. Supreme Court on Thursday once again prevented Missouri from using a congressional map in November that was redrawn to give Republicans an advantage in the midterm elections.

It was the second time this week that the Supreme Court waded into a dizzying legal fight over Missouri’s congressional map, and it came just two months before a general election in which the state’s voters could determine control of the House.

The court’s brief order did not include any reasoning, as is often the case when the justices respond to emergency requests. There were no noted dissents.

Denny Hoskins, the Missouri secretary of state, said in a statement on Thursday afternoon that his office was “directing local election authorities to use the 2022 congressional map,” not the redrawn one, in compliance with the Supreme Court order. That map would position Democrats to retain a seat in the Kansas City area.

The announcement from Mr. Hoskins amounted to a major win for redistricting opponents, who waged a yearlong fight against the new map. But it did not answer the question of how election officials would conduct a general election based on a map different from the one used in the primary in August.

Holding a general election with

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The rollout of Mayor Zohran Mamdani’s 2-K program in New York City has been mired in funding delays. PAGE A20

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A year after the Trump administration laid out its plan to improve the health of children, we look at results. PAGE A12

**INTERNATIONAL A4-11**  
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A cycle of retaliation over tariffs with President Trump could cause more pain at home than it would for the United States, economists say. PAGE A6

**A Battle for France’s Soul?**  
The founder of the Puy du Fou theme park says it gives the French a “founding narrative,” but critics say it peddles “far-right propaganda.” PAGE A8

**AfD Messaging Mirrors Putin’s**  
The far-right party, which may govern for the first time in a German state, embraces positions extolled by the Kremlin. PAGE A9



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**‘Are Sprinkles on the List?’**  
U.S. tariffs on a long list of Canadian products have companies scrambling to figure out what is affected. PAGE B1

**Asking A.I. About Elections**  
Voters consulting chatbots about political races may get answers that vary by who’s asking. PAGE B1

**WEEKEND ARTS C1-10**  
**Dudamel Lands in New York**  
“This is not a job — it is a mission,” said Gustavo Dudamel, the Philharmonic’s new conductor. He is starting a month of performances before taking the orchestra on a European tour. PAGE C1

**Unpacking Machismo Culture**  
The Tehran-born, Los Angeles-based artist Tala Madani has spent years investigating what makes men tick. Much of what she has found fits firmly in the realm of the absurd. PAGE C1

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**Radley Balko** PAGE A22



**SPORTS B6-10**  
**Cheery Guides to the Open**  
No matter the problem, the tournament’s ambassadors, upbeat, helpful and friendly, assist fans with questions, directions, even selfies. PAGE B7



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